

IBRAHIM H. ALSALEM, ChE

Data Scientist & Applied Economist | Chartered Economist | MSc Imperial College London | BSc Economics & Psychology, University of Michigan

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PROFILE

Applied economist and data scientist with 10+ years turning national-scale data into decisions that governments and boards act on. I take a problem end to end: define it, design the method, build the model and pipeline in Python, R, and Stata, put it in front of decision-makers through dashboards and briefings, and defend it in the room. Built and owned Saudi Arabia's national unemployment forecasting model, a foreign-worker remittance forecasting system integrating administrative data from 10+ government bodies, and the ministry's shadow-economy estimation — work whose findings fed into published national strategy documents and reached the highest levels of government. Deep labour-market, competitiveness, and policy domain expertise across the GCC, paired with the technical build. Chartered Economist (GAFM); native bilingual Arabic–English.

TECHNICAL & ANALYTICAL COMPETENCIES

Modelling & Machine Learning: Predictive modelling · Time-series forecasting (ARIMA, multi-year panel data) · Regression & econometric modelling · Impact evaluation · Clustering & segmentation modelling · Scenario simulation & sensitivity analysis · Demand and willingness-to-pay modelling

Data & Engineering: Python · R · Stata · SQL · Multi-source administrative data integration · Reproducible analytical pipelines · Survey and data-collection design

Visualisation & Delivery: Power BI · Tableau · R Shiny · Interactive dashboards and monitoring tools · Excel (Advanced) · Executive data storytelling

Economics & Policy: Labour-market economics · Index, ranking & benchmark construction · Policy and regulatory impact analysis · Competitiveness and sector research · Macroeconomic indicators

Domain: GCC markets & Vision 2030 · Public-sector and ministerial advisory · Cross-border analytics · Tourism, digital/technology, and consumer sectors

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Economic Consultant — Data & Strategy

2025 – Present

Basar Advisory · basaradvisory.com

Riyadh, KSA

- Deliver quantitative engagements end to end: built a consumer segmentation and willingness-to-pay model across the GCC and Jordan, then translated model output into a defensible pricing and market-entry strategy the client executed on.
- Design, build, and deploy interactive dashboards and sector-monitoring tools for clients — owning the full stack from data ingestion through modelling to the interface decision-makers actually use.
- Advise private-sector clients on sector research, demand modelling, and expansion strategy aligned with Vision 2030; maintain active modelling output in Python, R, and Stata.
- Completing CFI Business Intelligence & Data Analyst (BIDA); Financial Modeling & Valuation Analyst (FMVA) planned.

Economic Expert — Labour Market Policy

2023 – 2025

Ministry of Economy and Planning

Riyadh, KSA

- **Unemployment forecasting:** built and owned the national unemployment modelling and prediction workstream over multi-year datasets, from research design through data collection, model specification, and reporting — used to project labour-market trajectories under alternative policy scenarios.
- **Remittance forecasting:** designed a foreign-worker remittance forecasting system integrating multi-source administrative data in coordination with 10+ government bodies, reconciling conflicting definitions and reporting frequencies into a single modelled series and a repeatable pipeline.
- **Shadow-economy estimation:** produced the ministry's estimation of economic activity absent from official statistics, applying indirect estimation methods to quantify a deliberately unobserved sector.
- Lead researcher for the labour-market team; analysed the impact of labour-market policies and regulatory developments, producing research reports, technical notes, and policy briefs whose findings fed into published national strategy

documents.

- Communicated findings through decision-ready reports and presentations to ministerial leadership and inter-ministerial committees — translating model mechanics into conclusions non-technical principals could act on.

Assistant Commercial & Data Insight Manager

2023

Saudi Tourism Authority

Riyadh, KSA

- Built demand-pattern, segmentation, and predictive revenue models over consumer, economic, and behavioural data for the inbound tourism portfolio; benchmarked source markets competitively.
- Produced economic impact analyses and forecasts supporting multi-million SAR investment and commercial decisions.
- Designed and maintained executive dashboards communicating research findings to internal and external stakeholders.

Senior Analyst, Programs & Planning

2019 – 2020

Elm Company · Saudi Arabia's leading digital solutions and technology firm

Riyadh, KSA

- Led analytical workstreams across a national-scale digital project portfolio, applying scenario and sensitivity analysis within multi-year planning frameworks.
- Designed KPI scorecards and consolidated enterprise-wide budget forecasts, financial performance data, and delivery timelines into integrated reporting for senior leadership.

Associate Consultant

2018 – 2019

Strategic Gears · Management consulting

Riyadh, KSA

- Cross-sector research, benchmarking, and competitive intelligence for Saudi public and private clients across government, financial services, and consumer sectors.

Business Intelligence Analyst

2015 – 2018

Takamol Holding · Digital platforms for Vision 2030 labour-market reform

Riyadh, KSA

- Developed mathematical and econometric models in R and Stata supporting national labour-market research, including published topical reports on telework and adjacent workforce dynamics.
- Built the BI infrastructure for Takamol's e-learning platform; designed dashboards and simulations measuring programme effectiveness and supporting Vision 2030-aligned business cases.
- Served concurrently as analytical advisor to three VPs within the Saudi Employment Department.

Behavioural Economics Consultant (Part-time)

2017

Hawaz · Concurrent engagement during Takamol tenure

Riyadh, KSA

- Developed and presented a behavioural economics RFP submission to the Ministry of Health — bid won.

EDUCATION

MSc Economics & Strategy for Business — Merit

2020 – 2022

Imperial College London

London, UK

- Advanced econometrics, macroeconomic modelling, business strategy, and quantitative finance.

BSc Economics & BSc Psychology (Dual Degree), Minor in Mathematics

2010 – 2015

University of Michigan–Ann Arbor

Ann Arbor, MI, USA

- GPA 3.55 / 4.00 · Dean's List · Quantitative coursework in econometrics, statistics, behavioural science, and applied mathematics.

CREDENTIALS & LANGUAGES

Certifications: Chartered Economist (ChE) — GAFM, ID 81690725, valid through Apr 2028 · Advanced Data Storytelling — Boston University (2018) · BIDA (in progress) and FMVA (planned), Corporate Finance Institute

Languages: Native bilingual Arabic and English · Deep regional knowledge across the GCC through schooling, professional engagements, and an active regional network